

1 Te-forms of verbs



In this lesson, you will be learning what are called the “*te*-forms” of verbs. They are so called because most of them end with the sound /te/. The way a verb’s *te*-form is derived varies depending on the type of the verb, as seen in the following table:

Category		Dictionary form	<i>Te</i> -form
(a) <i>Ru</i> -verbs		たべる (to eat)	たべて
(b) <i>U</i> -verbs	Ending sound		
	う	かう (to buy)	かって
	つ	たつ (to stand up)	たって
	る	かえる (to return)	かえって
	む	よむ (to read)	よんで
	ぶ	あそぶ (to play)	あそんで
	ぬ	しぬ (to die)	しんで
	す	はなす (to talk)	はなして
	く	かく (to write)	かいて
		いく (to go)	いって (exception)
	ぐ	およぐ (to swim)	およいで
(c) Irregular verbs		する (to do)	して
		くる (to come)	きて

You can make the *te*-form from the dictionary form of a verb as follows:

(a) *Ru*-verbs: Change る to て.

(b) *U*-verbs:

- ・ う／つ／る ending: Change う／つ／る to って.
- ・ む／ぶ／ぬ ending: Change む／ぶ／ぬ to んで.
- ・ す ending: Change す to して.
- ・ く ending: Change く to いて. (Exception: いく → いって (× しいて))
- ・ ぐ ending: Change ぐ to いで.

(c) Irregular verbs: する → して ; くる → きて

(See the *te*-form song on p.204.)

Because verb *te*-forms are used in many important grammatical expressions (see #2-4 below, for example), you should work to make sure that you can always produce them correctly and automatically.

2 ~てください [Polite command] "Please V."



[2]

	V-te	
これを	読んで よ	ください。
Please read this.		

You can tell someone to do something politely and rather formally using V-te ください.

This expression is commonly used when a speaker of higher status than the listener tells the listener to do something (e.g., from a teacher to a student, from a manager to a subordinate, etc.), but it can also be used when the listener has the same status as the speaker does.

- Exs.** (1) 漢字で書いてください。 *Please write in kanji.*
かんじ か
 (2) ちょっと待ってください。 *Wait a moment, please.*
ま
 (3) もう一度言ってください。 *Say it again, please.*
いちど い

3 V₁-te V₂ [Actions in sequence] "V₁ and V₂"



[3]

	V ₁ -te	V ₂
今からジムに いま	行っ い	て運動します。 うんどう
I'm going to go to the gym now and exercise.		

When you describe two or more sequential actions by one person, you use *te*-forms. Note that と can connect only nouns; therefore, you cannot use it to describe situations like [3] above. (✕ 今からジムに行きますと運動します。)
いま うんどう

- Exs.** (1) 毎日6時に起きてジョギングします。 *I get up at six every day and jog.*
まいにち じ お
 (2) 昨日は映画を見て11時に寝ました。
きのう えいが み じ ね
Yesterday, I watched a movie and then went to bed at eleven o'clock.
 (3) 今晚いっしょに晩ご飯を作っ食べませんか。
こんばん ばん はん つく た
Would you like to make dinner and eat together tonight?

Note that *te*-forms carry no information about tense or politeness. Instead, that information is expressed by main verbs. For example, in (1), the tense and the politeness level are indicated by ジョギングします.

V₁-te V₂ is used in various situations. One situation is when two actions are an inseparable set of related actions (e.g., the first action sets up for the second action), as in [3] and (3) above, and another situation is when two actions are performed back to back, as in (1) and (2).

GID (vol.1): G. Connecting verbs, adjectives, and sentences using *te*-forms



In the following situation, the two actions are neither an inseparable set of related actions nor performed back to back. In this case, V₁-te V₂ is unnatural.

- ✕ 私は昨日図書館で勉強してジムで運動しました。
わたし きのう としよかん べんきょう うんどう
 → 私は昨日図書館で勉強しました。それから、ジムで運動しました。
わたし きのう としよかん べんきょう うんどう
I studied in the library yesterday. Then, I exercised at the gym.

4 ~ています

4-1 ~ています [Action in progress] “be V-ing”

できる
II

[4-a]

	V-te (continual verb)	
私は今、晩ご飯を わたし いま ばん はん	作って つく	います。
I am fixing dinner now.		

The meaning of V-te います varies depending on what kind of verb V-te is. By using V-te います with continual verbs (i.e., verbs that indicate an action with a duration), you can express an action in progress.

Exs. (1) にゃんたはリーマンさんと遊んでいます。Nyanta is playing with Riemann.
あそ

(2) アイさんは今、ダイエットしています。だから、ハンバーガーを食べません。
いま た
Ai is on a diet now, so she doesn't eat hamburgers.

(3) けいたさんは昨日の夜9時ごろに剣道を練習していました。
きのう よる じ けんどう れんしゅう
Keita was practicing kendo around 9 o'clock last night.

Lesson
6

4-2 ~ています [Resultant state] “be V-ed; be V-ing; be Adj; V”

できる
III

[4-b]

	V-te (momentary verb)	
今日、リサさんはかわいいセーターを きょう	着て き	います。
Lisa is wearing (lit. has put on) a cute sweater today.		

When a verb represents an action that signifies an instantaneous change and has no duration (e.g., to marry, to die, to learn of), V-te います expresses the state that remains after the action of V-te has completed.

Exs. (1) A: 田中さんはどこですか。Where is Tanaka-san?
たなか

B: リビングのソファに座っていますよ。
すわ
He's sitting on the sofa in the living room.

(2) 今日、山田さんは黒いシャツを着て(いて)、赤いネクタイをしています。
きょう やまだ くろ き あか
Yamada-san is wearing a black shirt and a red tie today.

(3) A: ジャンという人を知っていますか。Do you know a person named Jean?
ひと し

B1: はい、知っています。Yes, I do.
し

B2: いいえ、知りません。No, I don't.
し



知る means “to learn of,” so to express the idea of “to know,” which represents the resultant state of learning of something, you use 知っています. However, the equivalent form of “not to know” is not 知っていません but 知りません, as in (3)-B2. For the meanings of 行っています, 持っています, and 住んでいます, see [GID] (vol.1): E. Auxiliaries 2. (V-te) いる.



4-3 ~ています [Habitual action] “V”

できる
III



[4-c]

	V-te	
私はいつも6時に わたし じ	起きて お	います。
I always get up at six.		

You can also use V-te います to describe someone's habitual actions.

Exs. (1) テストの前_{まえ}にいつも友達_{ともだち}といっしょに勉強_{べんきょう}しています。

I always study with my friends before a test.

(2) 私は去年_{わたくし きょねん}、毎週_{まいしゅう}日曜日_{にちようび}にカフェでアルバイトをしていました。

I worked part-time at a café every Sunday last year.

(3) 私はたいていスマホで音楽_{おんがく}を聞_きいています。

I usually listen to music on my smartphone.

In Lesson 2, you learned that the non-past forms of verbs can also be used for habitual actions, as in (4). (See L2 #1.)

Ex. (4) 私は毎日朝6時_{わたくし まいにちあさ じ お}に起きます。 *I get up at six in the morning every day.*

For the difference between V-te います and V-non-past for habitual actions, see **GID** (vol.1): E. Auxiliaries 2-3. Habitual action.

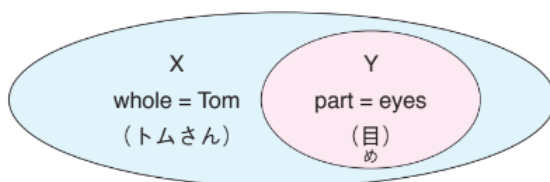


5 XはYがZ [X's physical characteristics] “X has Y that is Z; X's Y is Z”

できる
III

[5]

X (whole)		Y (part)		Z (Adj)
トムさん とおさん	は	目 め	が	大きいです。 おお
Tom has big eyes.				



You can describe the physical characteristics of someone or something by presenting that person or thing (=X) as a topic first and then adding a description of a specific part of it (=Y) using an adjective (=Z).

Exs. (1) にゃんたは足_{あし}が短_{みじか}いです。 *Nyanta has short legs.*

(2) 私はあまり背_せが高_{たか}くありません。 *I am not very tall (lit. As for me, [my] stature is not very high).*

(3) 私は子どもの時_{わたくし こ とき}、かみ_{かみ}が長_{なが}かったですが、今は短_{みじか}いです。

I had long hair when I was a child, but it's short now.

6 もう “already” and まだ “(not) yet”



[6-a]		V-past (affirmative)
もう	昼ご飯を ひる はん	食べました。 た
I've already had my lunch.		

[6-b]		V-te	
まだ	昼ご飯を ひる はん	食べて た	いません。
I haven't had my lunch yet.			

The adverbs もう and まだ can be used in combination with verbs in specific tenses to indicate whether or not an action has been completed. With “もう V-past,” you can express the idea that one has already done something, and with “まだ V-te いません,” the idea that one hasn't done something yet. The following sentence is ungrammatical.

✗ まだ昼ご飯を食べませんでした。 → まだ昼ご飯を食べていません。
ひる はん た ひる はん た

Exs. (1) A: もう明日の宿題をしましたか。
あした しゅくだい

Have you done tomorrow's homework yet? / Have you already done tomorrow's homework?

B: いいえ、まだしていません。 *No, I haven't done it yet.*

(2) A: もうサラダを作りましたか。
つく *Have you made the salad yet? / Have you already made the salad?*

B: はい、もう作りました。テーブルの上にあります。 *Yes, I have. It's on the table.*
つく うえ

GID (vol.1): D. Aspect 2. もう and まだ



7 X (period of time) に Y (number of times/duration) [Frequency/duration]



[7-a]		Period of time		Number of times/duration	
ここで	二日 ふつか	に	一回 いっかい	ミーティングがあります。	
There is a meeting here every other day (lit. once in two days).					

[7-b]	研さんは けん	一週間 いっしゅうかん	に	15 時間 じ かん	アルバイトをします。
Ken works 15 hours a week at his part-time job.					

You can describe the frequency of an action/event or the duration of an action/event in a given period using the pattern [Period of time] に [Number of times/duration].

Exs. (1) にゃんたは一日に四回ご飯を食べます。だから、ちょっと太っています。
いちにち よんかい はん た ふと

Nyanta eats four meals a day. Because of that, he is a little fat.

(2) オリンピックは四年に一回あります。
よ ねん いっかい *The Olympic Games are held once every four years.*

(3) 私は高校の時、一日に2時間ぐらい数学を勉強しました。
わたし こうこう とき いちにち じ かん すうがく べんきょう

When I was in high school, I studied math for about two hours a day.